

KNOWLEDGE ARTICLE

Outlook Email Not Sending, Receiving, or Syncing

Intent key	OutlookEmailSyncIssues	Category	Email and Collaboration
Routing	Bedrock Knowledge Base / LLM fallback	Lex overlap	No direct match in the supplied intent workbook

Purpose and intent scope

Use this article when Outlook is offline, messages are stuck in the Outbox, new mail is missing, folders are not updating, or the desktop client behaves differently from webmail.

Suggested answer

Please first confirm your internet connection and check whether Outlook is in Work Offline mode. Then run Send/Receive All Folders and compare the mailbox with webmail. If webmail works but Outlook does not, restart Outlook and the computer, check for a blocked message in the Outbox, and verify that the mailbox and local disk are not full. Share the exact error and whether webmail works so support can isolate the issue.

Common user utterances

- Outlook is not receiving new emails.
- My emails are stuck in the Outbox.
- Outlook says disconnected or trying to connect.
- My mailbox folders are not syncing.
- I can see mail in webmail but not in Outlook.
- Search is not finding recent messages.
- Outlook keeps asking for my password.
- Shared mailbox emails are not updating.

Recommended troubleshooting sequence

1. Confirm that the device has a working internet connection.
2. Check the Outlook status bar. If it shows Work Offline, select Send/Receive and turn Work Offline off.
3. Open webmail in a browser. If webmail works, the problem is likely limited to the desktop client or local Outlook profile.
4. Select Send/Receive All Folders and wait several minutes for synchronization to complete.
5. Open the Outbox and remove or save very large attachments before retrying. A single oversized or damaged message can block later messages.
6. Close Outlook completely and reopen it. If the process remains in the background, restart the computer.
7. Verify that the mailbox is not full and that the device has sufficient free disk space.
8. If Outlook repeatedly requests credentials, sign out and sign back in using the current corporate account. Do not approve unexpected MFA prompts.

Security and safety boundaries

Do not recommend the following actions:

- Do not delete the Outlook profile or local data file unless instructed by support.
- Do not send confidential files through a personal email account.
- Do not repeatedly approve MFA prompts that you did not initiate.

When to escalate

- Webmail is also unavailable.
- The mailbox is disabled, over quota, or reports a licensing error.
- The issue affects many users or a shared mailbox.
- Messages remain missing after Send/Receive and an application restart.
- Outlook crashes consistently or cannot open the mailbox.

Information to collect for support

- Exact error message
- Whether webmail works
- Time of the last successfully received message
- Whether sending, receiving, or both are affected
- Mailbox or shared mailbox name
- Outlook and operating-system version

Routing guidance for the assistant

Use this article when the request clearly matches the intent scope. Provide the suggested answer, then guide the user through the troubleshooting steps in order. Ask only for non-sensitive diagnostic details. If an escalation condition is met, recommend creating a support request and include the collected details. Never request passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or security tokens.

Knowledge-base note

This article was intentionally created for a topic not directly represented in the supplied Lex intent list. It is suitable for retrieval by an LLM fallback or Amazon Bedrock Knowledge Base. Internal service-desk URLs, approved software names, and organization-specific escalation paths should be added only after validation.